

Do you think this current system provides adequate accountability around short-term rentals in San Francisco? In your response, describe why you believe the system is adequate or inadequate. If you believe the system is inadequate, discuss a possible change in actions required to improve accountability in this system. You may refer to the SWE Code of Ethics as you think through your response.

I don't think that the current system provides adequate accountability for short term rentals in San Francisco. Since the system depends on complaints before the investigation happens, violations can continue unless someone notices and reports them. I think a better system would be to have periodic audits by the city before listings go live. This would shift the system from being reactive to preventive, preventing issues before they have a chance to cause harm.

As discussed in the introduction, the legality of web scraping is still uncertain in the US. Skim through the Legal Issues section of Web Scraping in the US on Wikipedia and this article about the legal issues with the Computer Fraud and Abuse Act, and describe at least one factor you believe is important to consider when discussing the legality of web scraping and why.

An important legal factor is unequal enforcement power. Large companies, including AI companies, can scrape massive public datasets from sites like GitHub or Stack Overflow and often avoid serious consequences because they have legal teams and resources to negotiate disputes. By contrast, ordinary people can face huge penalties much faster for similar cases, such as downloading textbooks from online. This imbalance makes legality feel less about consistent rules and more about who has the "power" to defend their actions.

Scraping public data does not always lead to positive results for society. For example, look to Facebook–Cambridge Analytica data scandal - Wikipedia or Clearview AI - Wikipedia. Many argue that using someone's personal data without their consent (even if publicly provided) is unethical. Web scraping requires thoughtful intervention. Develop at least two guidelines you think are important to consider when deciding whether to do web scraping.

I think two important guidelines for deciding whether to scrape data are, first, collecting only the minimum amount of data needed for a clear and legitimate purpose while avoiding sensitive personal information. Second, there should be accountability and transparency about what data is being scraped, why it is being collected, and how it will be used.